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Review
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"divine system is far from reassuring". Chapter 3, on allusion, includes a provocative discussion of how allusion on the part of characters can lead to irony; yet Lyne is not concerned with the problems inherent in assuming a fixed interpretation of "designed intertextuality". In Chapter 4 Lyne elaborates on what he calls "negative invention": Vergil suggests by omission (especially of characterizing speeches that the reader familiar with Homer would expect) that Aeneas is incapable of affective relationships, except when it is too late, an appealing explication of the troubling aspects of the hero's interactions with other characters. Chapter 5 briefly presents the "dramatic ironies" of the Shield, and of Anchises' advice to his son in Book 6. Chapter 6 summarizes Lyne's argument that "the *Aeneid* probes, questions, and occasionally subverts the simple Augustanism that it may appear to project; and it does this by means of its further voices".

This book, easy and pleasant to read, like a conversation with the author, shows that the interpretative conflict between "optimists" and "pessimists" is simplistic; the reader of the *Aeneid* must confront its ambiguities before searching for certainties. The book should be read by any serious critic of the *Aeneid* as well as by those who teach the poem in translation.

Haverford College ELIZABETH BLOCK
CW 82.4 (1989)

John Chadwick. *Linear B and Related Scripts*. Reading the Past, 1. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1987. Pp. 64, incl. 37 b/w ill. $6.95 (pb.). ISBN 0-520-06019-9.

This handsome pamphlet provides an exciting account of the discovery and decipherment of Linear B and a decription of the writing system, plus a stimulating introduction to the Mycenaean Greek texts themselves, and chapters on Linear A, the Cypriot scripts, and the Phaistos Disk. With its transliterated forms and non-technical style, the book makes an attractive supplement for secondary or undergraduate courses on the history and archaeology of the Greek Bronze Age. For graduate courses, the book is a useful introduction, before students consult more technical sources.

There are nevertheless some questionable features. The British spelling and locutions occasionally intrude on linguistic examples, as when the spelling *ough* is said to represent two different sounds in the words *though* and *borough*. The index could have been better. Despite the lavish illustrations of Mycenaean tablets (both photographs and line drawings), no single text is provided with a transcription, interpretation, and commentary, embodying the philological rigor Chadwick strives to inculcate.

Other problems are more substantive. The concluding diatribe against interpreters of the Phaistos Disk becomes overkill. In general, synchronic linguistic issues are handled well (especially writing systems and their relationship to sound systems, the focus of the book), but the diachronic perspective is slighted, partly via a laconic reticence to illustrate complex material (e.g. the development of the Indo-European labiovelars in Greek) with linguistic examples. When examples are provided, they are sometimes

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ill-chosen or poorly explained. Although deviations from Classical Greek are often pointed out, Greek and Indo-European historical linguistics are referred to only as tools for the interpretation of Mycenaean Greek; nowhere is the reader given a sense of the *linguistic* (vs. the cultural or historical) significance and excitement of the Mycenaean material. A question like the dialectal affiliation of Mycenaean is no arcane issue, but a matter of utmost interest for readers of Homer—i.e., much of the book's prospective audience.

Purists may object to Chadwick's dramatic scenario of attack from the sea and last-ditch attempts to appease the gods through human sacrifice. But our students seem to need this, nowadays, and we must be grateful that Chadwick has provided an attractive, engaging and authoritative initiation to the world of Mycenaean Greek.

Yale University BRENT VINE
CW 82.4 (1989)

Peter Bondanella. *The Eternal City: Roman Images in the Modern World.* Chapel Hill: The University of North Carolina Press, 1987. Pp. xiv, 286, incl. 76 b/w photos. $27.50. ISBN 0-8078-1740-6.

It is the perception of Rome more than the reality of Rome that has shaped our culture. Ever since the Renaissance, two diametrically opposed images of Roman antiquity have coexisted in the Western imagination: "the virtuous republic of selfless citizen-soldiers" (as portrayed by Livy) and "the corrupted empire of power-hungry and decadent tyrants" (as chronicled by Tacitus). The dramatic and moral tension between these two images explains Rome's enduring popularity as a source of cultural influence and inspiration second only to Christianity.

To support his thesis, the author describes the role of Rome in Western consciousness from the early Renaissance to the 20th century. Especially fascinating are his discussions of Fascist ideology and modern cinema.

The University of Windsor STEPHEN BERTMAN
CW 82.4 (1989)

J. P. Sullivan and Peter Whigham (edd.). *Epigrams of Martial Englished by Divers Hands.* Berkeley: University of California Press, 1987. Pp. x, 599. $58.00. ISBN 0-520-04340-9.

In this volume of selections, with the Latin of the 1976 Teubner on the facing page, appear approximately one third the number of epigrams contained in Martial's Twelve Books. A few epigrams are included from his earliest known work, the *Liber de Spectaculis*, and from Book XIII, *Xenia* and Book XIV, *Apophoreta*. The versions (imitation or translation in verse) of twentieth century scholars and poets (e.g. Michie, Pound, Pott, Wender and the editors) make up the main section of this book, with a few 19th century representations (e.g. by Stevenson), renderings from the 16th-18th centuries, and an *Appendix of Older Versions*. A few epigrams have more

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